

Nick Vatanshenas

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Computer Science B.S. 4.0 GPA

Los Angeles, CA

June 2026 – June 2028

Irvine Valley College

Computer Science A.S. 4.0 GPA

Irvine, CA

June 2024 – May 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C/C++, C#, Python, Java, Kotlin, Odin

Engines & Libraries: Unity, Godot, OpenGL, Raylib

Developer Tools: Git, VS Code, CMake, RAD Debugger, Docker, Linux, Claude Code, Bitbucket, Jira

PROJECTS — WRITE-UPS AND SOURCE CODE ON GITHUB

Custom Particle Engine | C++, 3D Simulation

August 2026 – Present

- Building a **3D C++ particle engine** from scratch using object-oriented design, implementing Verlet integration to handle physical behavior and dynamic particle motion
- Implementing an **Octree spatial partitioning structure** in C++ to manage dynamic 3D spatial queries and organize particle spatial data, debugging with RAD Debugger

Holstein Collection Inc. (Godot Wild Jam #96) | Lead Programmer, Godot, Python

August 2026

- Partnered with narrative writer in a **5-person team** to translate **story constraints into a Godot dialogue engine**, abstracting engine limitations so they could write natively in Twine (interactive story tool)
- Built an offline **Python** parser and Godot runtime loader to ingest Twine files into game data, eliminating manual hardcoding and securing a **top 12 finish out of 183 entries**

Trials of Yarbil | Custom Engine, Odin (C-like language), Steam

January 2024 – August 2025

- Built and shipped a top-down roguelike on **Steam** using Odin and Raylib, writing a **custom game engine** to manage update order, custom state updates, and interactions across distinct game objects
- Developed engine subsystems (smoothed **grid-partitioned A*** pathfinding, level editors, game state serialization), and gameplay mechanics, while publishing YouTube devlogs (**1,000+ views**) to iterate on design feedback

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern

July 2026 – September 2026

XP Health

- Upgraded a **Python** LLM evaluation framework on a **~15-engineer team** using **Claude Code**, creating an eval dataset from session logs and stubbing MCP/API clients, backed by **50+ new unit tests** and developer docs
- Fixed a **Kotlin** race-condition with a **thread-safe state handler**, eliminating UI result count discrepancies
- Delivered production features for an **Android** vision store via design docs, code reviews, and **feature flag rollout**, impacting **2,300+ annual users (20% of active app base)** and completing core deliverables **1 week ahead of schedule**

Software Developer Intern

January 2026 – June 2026

Castix LLC

- Profiled Unity performance bottlenecks** for an indie MMORPG, presenting a root-cause analysis on a **~25ms frame overhead**—caused by scene re-renders in a water plugin—to the **director** to guide optimization strategy
- Built **semi-automated Unity C# tools** to generate **primitive colliders from skeleton data** and automate prefab spawning, achieving a **10x setup speedup** for 400+ creatures and documenting handoffs for lead dev

LEADERSHIP

President

June 2025 – May 2026

IVC Computer Science Student Organization

- Led a **9-member board** to execute member-driven initiatives, **partnering with a recruited tech lead** to secure hardware funding and **assist ~10 students** during live technical workshops
- Instructed hands-on **Godot** workshops, mentoring members step-by-step from engine fundamentals to deploying their first playable web prototype on itch.io